DAY 23 OF 30

Same report, different rows

Row-level security.
One model, the right slice for each person.

RLS | Roles | Predicates

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THE PROBLEM

One report per region does not scale.

1	**5 regions**	5 copies of the report
2	**A new KPI**	Change it 5 times
3	**50 managers**	Nobody maintains 50 copies

Copies drift, and sooner or later **someone opens the wrong one**.

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THE SIMPLE VERSION

One report card per student.

A school prints one results system, not one per child. Each student opens it and sees only their own marks.

Row-level security does that for data: **one table, filtered by who is asking**.

✓ **One table**	Holds everyone's rows
✓ **A rule**	"Show rows where region is mine"
✓ **Each user**	Sees only their slice

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HOW IT WORKS

Where you can define it

1. **OneLake security**: on the table, enforced across engines
2. **Warehouse and SQL endpoint**: a T-SQL security policy
3. **Semantic model**: roles with a DAX filter
4. Pick **one place** as the source of truth

The closer to the data, the better

A rule on the table protects every tool. A rule in one report protects only that report.

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FOR ENGINEERS

The gaps you must know

SQL rules do not cover Spark

A security policy on the SQL endpoint does not protect direct access to the Delta files through a notebook.

Model rules apply to Viewers only

Admin, Member and Contributor roles on the workspace are not restricted by semantic model security.

Direct Lake behaves differently

With SQL rules, Direct Lake on SQL falls back to DirectQuery. Direct Lake on OneLake does not apply them at all.

Test as the user

Always check with a real restricted account. "It works for me" means nothing if you are an Admin.

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THE HONEST PART

Where should the rule live?

ON THE DATA	IN THE MODEL
Several tools read the same table	Only Power BI consumes the data
Engineers and analysts both query it	Rules depend on business hierarchies
The rule is a compliance requirement	Report authors own the logic

> **The catch:** security defined in two places will disagree. When it does, people see either too much or too little, and both end in an incident.

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FROM REAL WORK

Row-level security on a real project

A people-analytics platform holding sensitive personnel data.

1. **One set of tables** held employee data for the organisation
2. **Row-level security** filtered rows for each user
3. **Role-based access** controlled who entered at all
4. **Semantic models** carried the KPIs on top

One platform for everyone, **without everyone seeing everything**.

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SAVE THIS

RLS in five lines

1. **One table**, filtered per user
2. **Define it** as close to the data as you can
3. **SQL rules** do not protect Spark access
4. **Builders** in the workspace bypass model rules
5. **Test** with a restricted account

Tomorrow: Governance.
Lineage, labels and knowing what you have.

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Data Engineer | Databricks · AWS & Azure · Streaming · Applied AI

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